

LEVEL 3 · ADVANCED

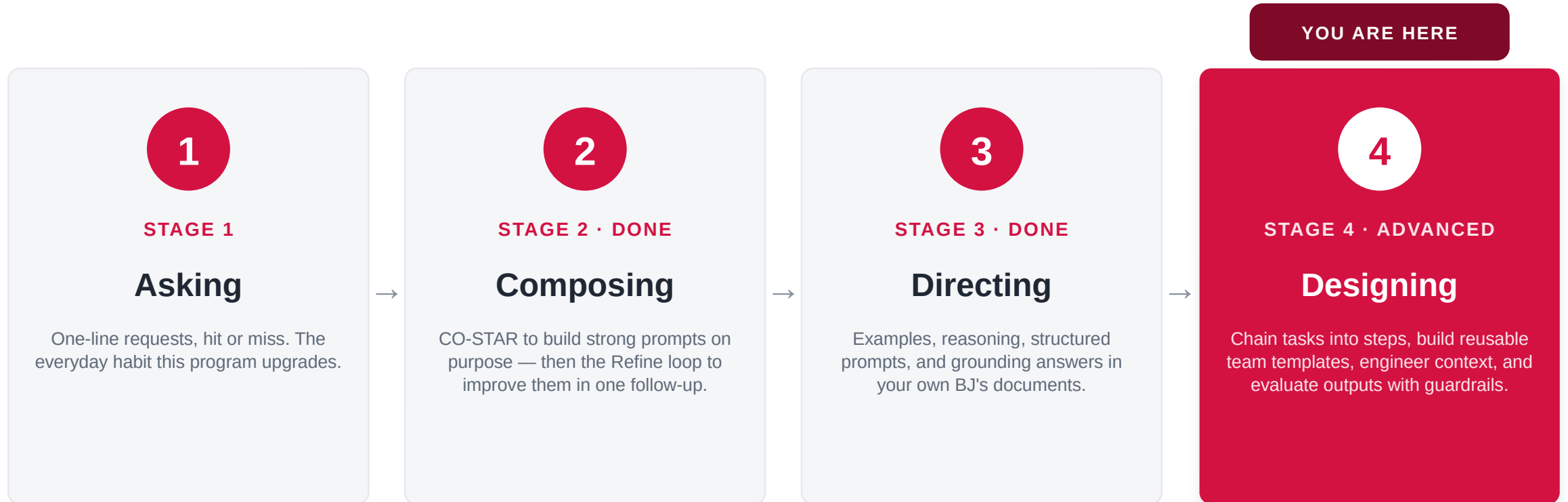
Prompt Engineering: From Directing to Designing

You can build a strong prompt and steer it well. The last step is designing — turning what works into reusable tools, and building in the checks that make them trustworthy.



YOUR LEARNING JOURNEY

From asking to designing — what each level of the program builds





RECAP · WHERE YOU LEFT OFF

You can compose, and you can direct

You've come a long way. In Beginner you learned to compose — CO-STAR and the Refine loop. In Intermediate you learned to direct — examples, reasoning, structure, your own documents, and deliberate diagnosis.

Advanced is the last step: designing. You'll take everything you can already do and turn it into reusable assets — chains, templates, and checks — that scale past you to your whole team.

YOUR STARTING POINT

Compose — CO-STAR + Refine.

Direct — examples, reasoning, structure, grounding.

Now: Design — build it to reuse.



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this module, you will be able to:

1

Chain a big task into steps

Break complex work into a sequence of smaller prompted steps.

2

Build a reusable template

A fill-in-the-blanks prompt your whole team can share.

3

Choose the right context

Include what the task needs and cut the rest.

4

Define “good” and A/B-test

Set success criteria, then compare two prompt versions.

5

Apply guardrails

Verify, cite, and keep member data safe.



WHY THIS MATTERS

The multiplier stage — build once, everyone benefits

Directing gets you a great answer on one task. Designing builds something that keeps working — a process, a template, a check — that you and your team run again and again without starting over.

This is where one Champion's well-built asset saves every colleague who uses it. It's how AI adoption spreads past you.

OUR RUNNING EXAMPLE

This week's club feedback — about 30 comments. Five of them:

“Waited 22 min at checkout — only 3 lanes open.”

“Rotisserie chicken is always fresh!”

“The app froze when I clipped the gas coupon.”

“Gas pump 4 is down again.”

“Wilted spinach and moldy berries in produce.”

We'll build the workflow that turns this into a manager summary — every Monday.



CHAIN THE WORK

Break a big task into a chain of steps

A complex job crammed into one giant prompt comes back shallow — it does a bit of everything and misses the important parts. Break it into steps, and feed each step's output into the next: first pull and tag the comments, then count and flag, then draft the summary.

Each step is small, checkable, and reliable — and you can fix one step without redoing the whole thing.

IN PRACTICE

Step 1 Pull every comment; tag theme + sentiment.

Step 2 Count themes; flag any safety issue.

Step 3 Draft a 5-bullet manager summary from Step 2.



CHAIN THE WORK

One giant ask vs. a chain of steps

ONE GIANT ASK

THE PROMPT

Summarize this week's feedback and tell me what to do.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Members had varied feedback this week — some waits and product-quality issues, plus positives on the fresh food. You may want to look into staffing and freshness.

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

One prompt juggling tag, count, flag and draft spreads attention thin — the rare safety item is what gets dropped.

A CHAIN OF STEPS

THE PROMPT

Step 1: tag each (theme+sentiment). Step 2: count; flag safety. Step 3: draft 5 bullets from Step 2.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Step 2 → Checkout 12, Produce 7, Food +5, App 4, Pump 1 (safety)

Step 3 → 'Safety: pump 4 — escalate. Checkout waits top volume...'

WHY IT WORKS

Each step does one job and hands checked work to the next — an error surfaces where it happened, not at the end.



REUSABLE TEMPLATES

Turn the winning prompt into a team tool

Once a prompt or chain works, don't retype it and don't keep it to yourself. Save it with blanks for the parts that change — the club, the week, the source — and add a standing instruction that sets how it should always behave. One Champion's prompt becomes the whole team's tool.

A new manager pastes it and gets it right on day one.

IN PRACTICE

Standing instruction: “You analyse BJ's club feedback. Always group by theme, count mentions, and flag safety first.”

Template: Summarise [SOURCE] for [CLUB], week of [DATE].



REUSABLE TEMPLATES

Everyone rolls their own vs. one shared template

EVERYONE ROLLS THEIR OWN

THE PROMPT

(three managers, three different prompts)

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Club A: 'Lots of complaints about the lines.'

Club B: bullet list, no counts.

Club C: one paragraph, different order.

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

Eight people improvising means the quality lives in their heads — it varies by author and leaves when they do.

ONE SHARED TEMPLATE

THE PROMPT

System: always group, count, flag safety. Template: Summarise [SOURCE] for [CLUB], week of [DATE].

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Every club, same shape:

'Safety: pump 4. Checkout — 12. Produce — 7. App — 4. Fresh food +5.'

WHY IT WORKS

The standing instruction carries the standard; the blanks carry the week. One person's best prompt becomes the floor.



CHOOSE THE RIGHT CONTEXT

With lots of material, more isn't better

When there's a mountain of material, the instinct is to paste all of it. But too much buries the signal — the model spreads its attention thin and the important thing gets lost. The better move is to choose: include what the task needs, cut the rest.

For the weekly summary, this week's comments plus last week's counts beat three months of raw archive.

IN PRACTICE

Include: this week's comments + last week's theme counts (for trend).

Leave out: the 3-month raw archive and unrelated HQ memos.



CHOOSE THE RIGHT CONTEXT

Dump everything vs. right-sized context

DUMP EVERYTHING

THE PROMPT

Summarize. (pastes 3 months of comments)

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Over the past quarter, feedback covered checkout, produce, the app, and gas — broadly consistent themes throughout.

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

Three months of noise drowned this week's signal — attention spread across everything means depth on nothing.

RIGHT-SIZED CONTEXT

THE PROMPT

Summarize this week's comments; compare to last week's counts (below).

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Checkout waits jumped 5 → 12 this week — a clear spike. Produce steady at 7. Suggest a look at weekend staffing.

WHY IT WORKS

This week plus one baseline is exactly enough to see change — the spike stands out once the noise is gone.



DEFINE GOOD, THEN TEST

Know what “good” means before you trust it

“How do I know it's good?” is the gap between a dabbler and a builder. Decide what good means up front — accurate counts, safety flagged, five bullets, plain language — then run two versions of your prompt on the same week and score each against those criteria. Keep the winner.

That's how a template earns its place, instead of just feeling right.

IN PRACTICE

Good = correct counts · safety flagged · ≤5 bullets · plain language.

Run A and B on this week's feedback — which meets all four?



DEFINE GOOD, THEN TEST

“Looks fine” vs. scored against criteria

“LOOKS FINE” — eyeball version A

THE PROMPT

(read it, looks good, ship it)

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Checkout waits — 10. Produce — 7. Good week overall.

(Count is off, and no safety flag.)

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

Reading for tone grades the writing, but the errors live in the facts — exactly where 'looks fine' never checks.

SCORED A/B

THE PROMPT

Good = correct counts · safety flagged · ≤5 bullets · plain language. Which version meets all four?

WHAT YOU GET BACK

A: counts off, no safety → fails.

B: 'Pump 4 (safety); Checkout — 12...' → meets all four. Keep B.

WHY IT WORKS

Four written criteria turn 'seems good' into a checklist — B wins for reasons you can show, not a feeling.



GUARDRAILS & RESPONSIBLE USE

Build the checks in, not on

Better prompting means feeding in more real material — so responsible use rides along with the technique, not as an afterthought. Ground claims in the source, tell it to cite or say when it's unsure, verify names and numbers before anything goes out, and never paste a member's personal details or confidential data. Use the tools BJ's has approved.

A trustworthy asset has these checks built into it.

THE CHECKLIST

- ✓ Ground it in the source
- ✓ Cite, or say when unsure
- ✓ Verify names & numbers
- ✓ Keep member data out



GUARDRAILS & RESPONSIBLE USE

Unguarded vs. guardrailed

UNGUARDED

THE PROMPT

Summarize and add some detail.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Satisfaction was around 82%. Member Jane Smith complained pump 4 was down.

(Invented stat, and a member's name exposed.)

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

'Add detail' with no source is an instruction to invent — and a pasted name rides straight into the output.

GUARDRAILED

THE PROMPT

Use only the comments. Cite a quote or say 'not stated'. No member names.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

- Gas pump — 1 ('pump 4 down again'). Safety.
 - Satisfaction score — not stated.
- (No names included.)

WHY IT WORKS

Source-only, cite-or-say-not-stated, no names: the rules leave nothing to invent and nothing to leak.



LIVE DEMO · BEFORE

One giant ask

▶ PASTE THIS INTO CLAUDE

Summarize this week's club feedback and tell me what to do.

[this week's club feedback pasted here]

WHAT YOU GET BACK

This week members gave a range of feedback. There were complaints about wait times and some product-quality issues, plus positive notes on the fresh food. You may want to look into staffing and check on product freshness.

→ **Vague and unranked — and it buries the one safety issue.**



LIVE DEMO · AFTER

Chained, templated, guardrailed

▶ PASTE THIS INTO CLAUDE

System: You analyse BJ's club feedback. Always group by theme, count mentions, flag safety first, quote an example, and say 'not stated' rather than guess. Five bullets, plain language.

Summarise the feedback below for Club #124, week of Jul 6 — then give the manager's top action.

[this week's feedback]

WHAT YOU GET BACK

MANAGER SUMMARY — Club #124, wk Jul 6

- Safety: pump 4 down — 1 ('down again'). Escalate to maintenance today.
- Checkout waits — 12 ('only 3 lanes open'). Top-volume issue.
- Produce quality — 7 ('wilted spinach, moldy berries').
- App issues — 4 ('froze on the gas coupon').
- Fresh food — 5 positive ('rotisserie chicken always fresh').

TOP ACTION: Fix pump 4 (safety), then add weekend checkout staffing.

→ **Ranked, cited, safety-first — ready to send to the manager.**



WHAT YOU CAN NOW DO

You can design, not just direct



Chain a big task

Smaller steps, each checkable.



Build a reusable template

One asset your whole team shares.



Choose the right context

Include what helps; cut the rest.



Define good and A/B-test

Pick the winner on evidence.



Apply guardrails

Grounded, verified, member data safe.



You've completed the journey

Now go build one asset for your team.



KEEP-AT-YOUR-DESK CARD

Your Advanced moves, one card

1

Chain Break big tasks into small, checkable steps.

2

Templates Save the winning prompt with blanks; add a standing instruction.

3

Context Include what the task needs; cut the rest.

4

Evaluate Define “good,” then A/B on the same input.

5

Guardrails Ground, cite, verify, keep member data out.

▶

Designing You're building tools other people reuse.



YOU'VE COMPLETED THE JOURNEY

Now build one thing your team reuses

Pick one weekly task you own. Turn it into a saved template or a short chain, define what “good” looks like, and share it with your team. That's designing — and that's how AI adoption spreads past you.

OPTIONAL — GO DEEPER

Appendix

Optional extras — a self-check habit and where to go next. Dip in when you want to go deeper.



OPTIONAL

Have it check its own work

A powerful habit for a finished asset: after it drafts, ask it to critique its own output against your criteria, then produce a fixed version. It often catches its own miscounts and omissions — a built-in second pair of eyes before anything reaches a person.

Pair this with your evaluation criteria for a self-improving template.

THE IDEA

Here's your draft summary. List where it fails any of the four criteria — counts, safety flag, five bullets, plain language — then give me a corrected version.



EXAMPLE

Accept the first draft vs. critique-then-revise

ACCEPT THE FIRST DRAFT

THE PROMPT

(send the first summary as-is)

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Checkout — 10. Produce — 7. Fresh food — 5.
(No safety note.)

WHY IT FALLS SHORT

A quick read grades flow, not facts — a miscount and a missing flag don't look wrong on the page.

CRITIQUE-THEN-REVISE

THE PROMPT

Check your draft against the four criteria, then fix it.

WHAT YOU GET BACK

Found: checkout miscount (10 → 12); safety flag missing.
Fixed: 'Pump 4 (safety); Checkout — 12; Produce — 7...'

WHY IT WORKS

Checking against criteria is a different task than drafting — the review pass catches what the writing pass slid past.



GO FURTHER

Where designing leads next



Ask more than once

Run a prompt a few times and compare — steadier answers on tough calls.



Let it plan and act

Tools that plan, act, and check in a loop — the next frontier.



Pull in your documents

Systems that fetch the right source automatically as you ask.



Start a prompt library

Collect your team's best prompts and templates in one shared place.